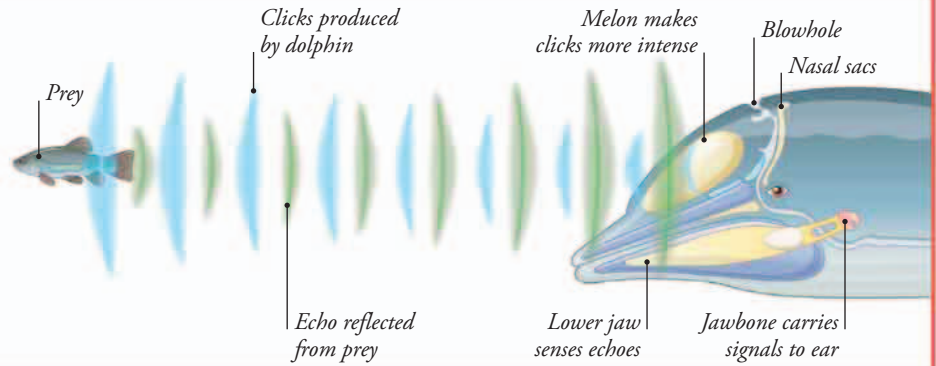


ECHOLOCATION

Dolphins and other toothed whales locate their prey by emitting loud clicks that echo off the target. The returning echoes create a “sound image” of the prey’s location. The dolphin’s clicks are generated in nasal sacs near its blowhole (nostril), and focused by an organ in its forehead called the melon. The echoes are picked up by nerves in its lower jaw and carried to its ears.



TOOTHED GIANT

Most toothed whales are much smaller than the average baleen whale, but the sperm whale is a giant. It can grow up to 66 ft (20 m) long, and has a huge box-shaped head that is mostly filled with a waxy substance called spermaceti. This seems to help the whale adjust its buoyancy, allowing it to dive to incredible depths.

◀ SPERM WHALE

A hunting sperm whale may dive 2 miles (3 km) below the waves in search of prey. It can stay underwater for more than an hour before surfacing to breathe.



HORNED WHALE

The narwhal is a medium-sized whale that lives in the Arctic Ocean. Its unique feature is a spiral tusk that projects for up to 10 ft (3 m) from the male’s upper jaw. The exact function of this tusk is still a mystery. It was once extremely valuable, because people who had never seen a narwhal thought the tusk was the horn of the legendary unicorn, and had magical powers.

▲ NARWHALS

Narwhals often gather in large groups—sometimes several hundred strong. They stay close to broken pack ice with plenty of breathing holes.

